

Predicted Questions: Your CIB Insight Job Simulation

Contents

Part 1 — The headline numbers (your actual question)

Part 2 — Why the questions are predictable (the posting gave the game away)

Part 3 — The predicted questions, tier by tier

Part 4 — Timing tactics per item type

Part 5 — Your countdown plan (deadline ≈ one week out)

Honesty notes

Source list

For: Janak · **Prepared:** 12 August 2026 · **Programme:** Corporate & Institutional Banking — Graduate Insight Programme, London (insight day 4 September 2026) · **Assessment:** the Cappfinity Job Simulation from your invite (~30 minutes, 10-day window).

What this document does. You pasted the actual job posting. That changes the game, because the posting's **"Who you are" section is the marking rubric published in plain sight** — Cappfinity scores you against a "success profile" for the specific role, and those five bullet points *are* the profile. So this briefing: (1) pins down **how many questions, how long to prepare, how long to answer**; (2) **predicts the questions** tier by tier, with the trait each one probes; and (3) maps every prediction to the answer you've already built in your playbooks. Predictions are informed estimates **INFERRED** built on verified mechanics **OFFICIAL** **CORROBORATED** — exact wording on the day will differ, which is what your decoder is for.

Part 1 — The headline numbers (your actual question)

Question	Best answer	Confidence
How many items in total?	~15 items across 4 exercises ("tiles") — a mix of video, ranking, personality scales and one written email	CORROBORATED ^{[1][2]}
How many recorded VIDEO questions?	3–5 (plus 1 unscored-ish warm-up)	CORROBORATED ^{[1][3]}
How long to PREPARE per video question?	~2 minutes (HSBC's usual setting; Cappfinity's generic default elsewhere is 30 seconds — the on-screen timer is the authority)	CORROBORATED ^{[1][4]} , disputed range
How long to ANSWER per video question?	Up to ~2 minutes, auto-stop at the limit (one source says up to 3 — again, trust the on-screen timer)	CORROBORATED ^{[1][3]} , disputed range
Re-record?	No — one take for assessed questions. The warm-up can be re-done until camera/sound are right	OFFICIAL — Cappfinity ^[4]
Total sitting time?	Your invite says ~30 minutes typical; prep sources say 35–50. Budget 45 minutes undisturbed	OFFICIAL invite / CORROBORATED ^{[1][2]}
Timed overall?	No — untimed as a whole (only the video clocks run), but time taken is recorded and can inform the decision — steady pace, no marathon pauses	CORROBORATED ^[5]
Deadline?	10 days from your invite email — sit it 2–3 days before the deadline , fresh, mid-morning. Don't run it to the wire in case of tech issues	INFERRED

Anatomy of your ~30–45 minute sitting (typical shape)

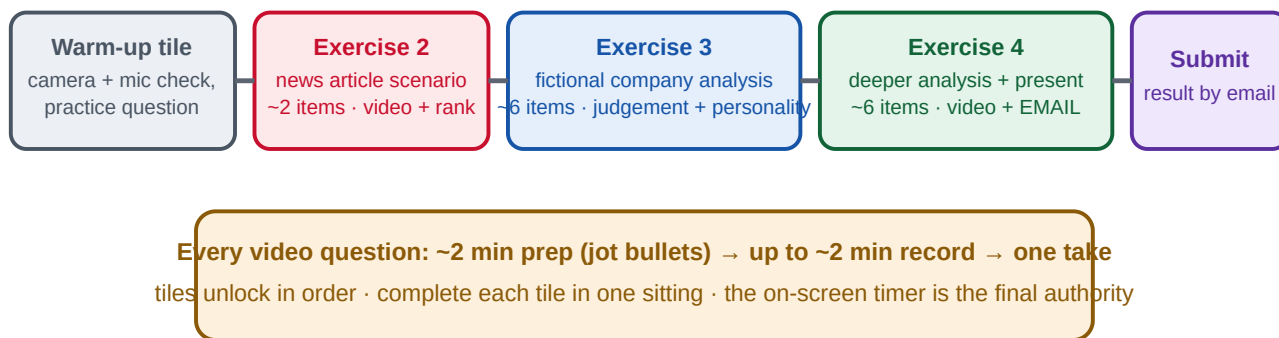


Diagram 1 — The typical shape of the sitting. Exact tile names and counts vary by cycle — HSBC tailors content — so treat this as the map, not the territory. **CORROBORATED** structure ^{[1][2]}

Part 2 — Why the questions are predictable (the posting gave the game away)

Two facts make prediction possible:

1. Cappfinity scores against a "success profile" for the specific role and intake

CORROBORATED ^[5] — a defined list of traits the role rewards. And your posting *publishes* it. The "Who you are" section names exactly five: **intellectually curious · a natural team player · a problem-solver · detail-focused · analytical by nature**. Add HSBC's four values and motivation, and you have the complete target list. Every question in your simulation exists to give you a chance to evidence one of these. **INFERRED**

2. The "What you'll do" section describes the simulation's storyline. The insight day promises: relationship-building with clients · Relationship Managers partnering with Trade Finance, Cash Management, Capital Markets, and Markets & Securities Services · thinking about **profitability and risk · analysing information and contributing to presentations**. Job simulations are "day in the life" previews of exactly this — so expect the fictional scenario to be **a research/analysis task for a client or company, ending in a presentation or recommendation**, which matches the known exercise structure (news-article research task → company analysis → present to stakeholders + email) **CORROBORATED** ^{[1][2]}. **INFERRED**

The trait-to-question map (this is the prediction engine):

Posting trait	The question type it forces	Your prepared answer lives in
Intellectually curious	motivation ("why does this interest you"), how-you'd-start-research	First-principles doc §B2; Playbook Part 3
Natural team player	new-team/introduce-yourself video; teamwork ranking items	Playbook Part 2; video playbook §8
Problem-solver	prioritisation/triage scenarios; the email task	Playbook Parts 2 & 6
Detail-focused	data-reading items; consistency across your answers	steady pace, read twice
Analytical by nature	chart/table questions; "what does this data suggest" video	Playbook Part 4 structure

Part 3 — The predicted questions, tier by tier

Tier 1 — plan for these (high confidence). Each with the wording variants most reported, what it probes, and your move.

- 1. The warm-up / intro video.** *"Introduce yourself" / "Tell us about yourself" / "What's your biggest strength?"* — Officially a tech check; **treat it as scored** (sources conflict) ^{[2][4]}. **Your move:** the Present → Path → Future intro from the playbook, with your one light humour line. This is the freebie — deliver it properly.
- 2. The motivation video.** *"Why do you want to join this programme / HSBC / Corporate and Institutional Banking?" or "What interests you about this area?"* — Probes: curiosity + motivation, the posting's first trait. **Your move:** your 15-second contents section + one named deal + the 62% number. This is where all your firm research cashes in — almost no insight-stage candidate can answer at your level.
- 3. The new-team / working-with-others video.** *"You're joining a new team where you know nobody / senior colleagues you've never met — how do you introduce yourself and build relationships?"* — The single most-reported job-sim video prompt ^[6]. Probes: team player + *We succeed together*. **Your move:** posture → listen-first actions → deliver-small-things-early, closing on learning from different perspectives.
- 4. The research-task scenario (video and/or ranking).** After reading the fictional **news article:** *"How would you approach starting this research project?" / "What would you look at first and*

why?" — Probes: curious + analytical + problem-solver. **Your move:** a simple method, said aloud: *goal first* → *what do we know / not know* → *prioritise the two things that matter most* → *who I'd ask* → *deadline check*. Method beats content — they're marking *how you think*.

5. **Prioritisation / judgement rankings.** Scenario with ~5 possible actions, **rank 1–5 most-to-least likely**. Expect: competing deadlines, a colleague needing help, a quality problem spotted late, unequal participation in a meeting. Probes: problem-solver + values. **Your move:** rank by the values — collaborative, responsible options high; ignoring, blaming, or going-over-heads options low; decisive beats fence-sitting. Answer as you genuinely would.
6. **The written email.** "*Reply to this email from your manager/colleague*" — often *which request do we handle first and why*, or *summarise what the data suggests* (~2,000–3,000 characters, typed live) [1][3]. Probes: problem-solver + detail + communication. **Your move:** acknowledge → triage with a stated "why first" → recommend from the given data → own the next step.
7. **Personality / work-style scales.** Slider pairs (e.g. "*I like variety*" vs "*I see one thing through*"), possibly asking both *what you'd do* and *what you'd enjoy* — the strengths signature [5]. **Your move:** honest and consistent. These calibrate the authenticity check that runs across everything else.

Tier 2 — likely (prepare, lighter).

8. **A data-interpretation item** — a chart/table from the fictional company: "*What does this data suggest?*" / "*Which option does the data support?*" (mirrors "bring data to life" from the posting). Read units and dates twice; calculator on desk.
9. **A "different perspectives" scenario** — a colleague disagrees or a quieter voice isn't heard (probes *We value difference*). Take the other view seriously; the outcome improves because of it.
10. **A strengths video** — "*What would you bring to the team?*" / "*What are you good at?*" One strength → proof → fit.
11. **A pressure/adaptability item** — plans change late, information is incomplete (probes *We get it done*). Calm triage; "make it reversible, then decide."

Tier 3 — possible (don't over-invest, have one line ready).

12. **Commercial awareness** — "*a news story you've followed*" (rarer in the sim than in later interviews, but your two warm events make it free marks if it appears).
13. **Free time / what energises you** — truth → driver → light bridge.
14. **Ethics-flavoured ranking** — usually appears as an SJT option rather than a video; the "check facts → proper channel" ladder handles it.

What will NOT come up CORROBORATED — consistent candidate reports [2][6]: valuation or accounting technicals, brainteasers, coding, or a formal commercial-awareness exam. Do not spend

your remaining days on those.

Part 4 — Timing tactics per item type

- **Video (~2 min prep / ~2 min record):** spend prep jotting **4 bullets max** (opener → example → what-it-shows → close). Start speaking within the first seconds of the recording, front-load the point, land the close by ~1:40 so the auto-stop never cuts you. If you finish at 1:30 with everything said — **stop**. A complete 90 seconds beats a padded 120.
- **Rankings:** ~60–90 seconds each. First instinct on the best and worst options, then order the middle. Don't re-litigate; consistency across scenarios matters more than any single item.
- **Personality scales:** quick and honest — overthinking these *creates* the inconsistency the system flags.
- **Email:** ~8–10 minutes. One read of the materials, four-move structure, one proofread pass. Under the cap with room to spare.
- **Between tiles:** breathe, sip water, reset. **Within a tile:** one continuous focused sitting ^[4].

Part 5 — Your countdown plan (deadline ≈ one week out)

- **Today / Day 1:** fill the story-bank grid (playbook Part 1). Lock your intro, your motivation answer (contents section + deal + number), and the new-team answer. Say each out loud twice from bullets.
 - **Day 2:** run the drill — record intro, motivation, new-team, and one "how I'd start research" answer on your phone, one take each, no restarts. Review against: point-first? one story? smiled once? landed by 1:40?
 - **Day 3:** the email rehearsal (10-minute timer, four moves, typed) + 20 minutes of ranking-style judgement questions on the Preparation Plus portal. Re-check your two news events.
 - **Day 4 or 5 — SIT IT**, mid-morning, fresh: quiet room, front light, one device, home connection, notifications off, calculator + paper, warm-up done properly (re-record it until sound and framing are right — that's allowed ^[4]).
 - **Keep 2 buffer days** before the deadline for any technical failure (genuine tech issues reported promptly are the one thing that gets re-issued).
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Honesty notes

- **The predictions are informed estimates.** The mechanics (counts, timings, structure, no-re-record) are **OFFICIAL**/CORROBORATED; the specific question list is **INFERRED** from the published success profile, the known exercise structure, and candidate-reported prompts. Expect the *types* to hold and the *wording* to differ — the decoder covers the gap.
- **Disputed numbers, flagged:** prep time (2 min vs 30 sec), record time (2 vs 3 min), total (30 vs 50 min). In every case **the on-screen instruction in your sitting is the authority** — read it, don't assume.
- Your invite's "~30 minutes" is the freshest signal and suggests the leaner configuration — consistent with 3–4 videos rather than 5–6.
- One take, human-reviewed, authenticity-checked: rehearse **structures from bullets**, never scripts — and the words you say on camera must be your own ^[4]^[7].

Source list

1. JobTestPrep — The 4 micro-exercises of the HSBC Job Simulation (counts; 2 min prep / 2 min record; email task) — <https://www.jobtestprep.co.uk/hsbc-assessment-centre>
2. Psychometric Success — HSBC Online Job Simulation (structure; ~15 items; email ~3,000 characters) — <https://psychometric-success.com/aptitude-tests/test-types/hsbc-online-job-simulation>
3. GraduatesFirst — HSBC Job Simulation / video interview (3–5 video questions; formats) — <http://www.graduatesfirst.com/hsbc-job-simulation>
4. Cappfinity help desk — re-record policy (assessed = one take; warm-up repeatable; timing shown per question) — <https://capphelpdesk.zendesk.com/hc/en-us/articles/4402640631953-Will-I-be-able-to-re-record-a-video-response>
5. Intervyo / Cappfinity methodology — success-profile scoring; time recorded; dual do/enjoy ratings; consistency checks — <https://www.intervyo.co.uk/assessments/cappfinity>
6. Candidate-reported prompt bank (The Student Room, Wall Street Oasis, Glassdoor, MockQuestions — full citations in your video playbook) — see **hsbc-video-interview-playbook.pdf**
7. HSBC — Application hints and tips (no generated answers on camera; explain/validate/replicate) — <https://www.hsbc.com/careers/application-hints-and-tips>
8. HSBC — the job posting itself: Corporate & Institutional Banking Graduate Insight Programme, London (the five-trait success profile; "What you'll do") — <https://apply.careers.hsbc.com/emergingtalent/job/London-Corporate-and-Institutional-Banking-Graduate-Insight-Programme-E14-5HQ/1367637057>

Compiled 12 August 2026. Mechanics verified; question list is a prediction built from the published success profile and candidate reports — hold it loosely, trust the decoder, and read every on-screen instruction on the day.

Self-contained briefing · rendered from `hsbc-assessment-briefing.md` · 8 August 2026. Reliability labels reflect the evidence at that date; HSBC's process changes frequently.